MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 1, Episode 8

"High Water"

Episode 1x08. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 1x08. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Monday, August 22, 2005, 8:00 AM (cold open), then Monday, August 29, 2005, 4:52 AM through Tuesday, August 30, 2005, 7:24 AM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 41 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-1x07

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Monday, August 29, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Monday, August 29, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Loretta Wise	Staff Psychiatrist (EAP)	Nov 11, 1950	54
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	25
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (16 weeks pregnant; 28th birthday)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending Breast and General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	58
Danielle Pryor (new)	Patient: BRCA1 carrier	Feb 17, 1979	26
Kevin Hollis (new)	Danielle's fiance	Nov 2, 1975	29
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Mother Ozella Rivers (new)	Patient: frontal meningioma	Jan 30, 1934	71
Bernice Rivers-Lane (new)	Ozella's daughter	Jun 6, 1957	48
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	25
Curtis Lemieux (new)	Patient: dilated cardiomyopathy, Status 1A	Apr 9, 1961	44
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband	Apr 3, 1975	30
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	Esther's estranged husband (V.O. only)	Mar 3, 1971	34
Nurse Kendra Wallace	Surgical Floor Nurse	May 30, 1980	25
Lillian Divine	Harmony's mother (V.O.)	Feb 14, 1952	53
Howard Divine	Harmony's father (V.O.)	Aug 30, 1950	54
Dr. Cynthia Braxton (new)	Breast Radiologist	May 21, 1960	45
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Nurse Pauline Greer (new)	OR Circulating Nurse	Oct 3, 1965	39
Rev. Wendell Amos (new)	Hospital Chaplain	Jul 19, 1944	61

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	42
Gladys Hollis (new)	Kevin's mother	Mar 12, 1948	57
Ahmad Cummings	Arianna's brother (V.O.)	Sep 9, 1984	20

Also appearing: an OB ultrasound tech, CCU nurses, a phone recording (V.O.), Devonte (5) and his mother, Kevin's two brothers, Mrs. Delgado and the Rosary group, and CNN anchors (on TV). Mentioned: Dr. Victor Donohue (flowers and a card), Grace Bullock (on the phone), Dr. Joan Mercer, Odile and Lionel Lemieux, Tasha (Gulfport), Desmond, and Walter Bullock (d. 1999).

Black don't crack (C-018): every regular reads several years younger than their age on screen. The ages above are exact and binding.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - HUNTERS POINT BUILDING - SUITE 410 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 22, 2005 - 8:00 AM

A small office that doesn't look like a hospital: two armchairs, a box of tissues, a window looking out at the 7 train. On the wall hangs a framed sepia photograph of a brick storefront with a hand-painted sign: "WILLIAMS DREAMLAND THEATRE - GREENWOOD AVE."

DR. LORETTA WISE (54), silver locs pinned up, reading glasses on a beaded chain, sits in one chair. Marc (26), in a pressed shirt and slacks, sits very straight in the other, like a man at a job interview.

DR. WISE
Good morning, Dr. Bullock.

MARC
Good morning, ma'am.

DR. WISE
How did you sleep?

MARC
Very well, ma'am. Eight hours. Saturday and Sunday. I had oxtails at my parents' house. I've been eating three meals a day. I took a walk along the river.

DR. WISE
(writing nothing)
You rehearsed that.

MARC
(beat)
A little, ma'am.

DR. WISE
That's four "ma'ams" in under a minute. (beat) In my experience, a young man who says "ma'am" that often is either from the South or hiding something. You're from the Upper West Side.

Marc opens his mouth. Closes it.

DR. WISE
(pleasantly)
Tell me about Thursday.

MARC
A man burned a four-year-old with cigarettes. He went for the boy's sister. I stopped him.

DR. WISE
And then?

MARC
(beat)
And then I didn't stop.

DR. WISE
Thank you. That's the first true thing you've said since you sat down. (beat) What does it feel like? When you don't stop?

MARC
(quiet)
Quiet. (beat) Everybody thinks it's loud. It's loud on the outside. On the inside it's the quietest I ever get. No worrying about whether I'm good enough, or who's watching, or what my name means. Just... one thing that's wrong, and me.

DR. WISE
(taking off her glasses)
That's a very honest answer, and a very dangerous one. (beat) You know what that photograph is?

MARC
(looking at it)
Greenwood. Tulsa.

DR. WISE
My grandmother's movie theater. 1921. It burned with the rest of Black Wall Street. (beat) She rebuilt it. Ran it until 1955. And every time somebody asked her why she wasn't angry, she said, "I'm angry every day, baby. I just decide every day where to put it."

MARC
(beat)
Where did she put it?

DR. WISE
Into a ticket booth. Into eleven grandchildren. Into me. (beat) You're going to have to decide where you put yours, Dr. Bullock. Because a surgeon whose quietest place is the middle of a fight is going to lose a patient or a license one day. Probably both.

Marc looks at the photograph for a long time.

MARC
Are you going to clear me?

DR. WISE
(putting her glasses back on, signing a form)
I'm clearing you for duty starting tomorrow. No more than eighty hours a week, which is the law anyway, and no picking up extra shifts with Dr. Crump, which I've already told Dr. Crump. (beat) And when it happens again, and it will, you come back and sit in that chair. Not because the Chief sends you. Because you choose to.

MARC
(standing)
Yes, ma... (catching himself) Yes. Thank you, Dr. Wise.

DR. WISE
(not looking up)
Better.

2 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - THE BOARD - DAY
TUESDAY, AUGUST 23, 2005 - 5:58 AM

The surgical board, the scheduling wall that runs the hospital. Interns crowd around it with coffee. Marc walks in, in scrubs again, his ID back on its clip. The room goes quiet.

Arianna (25) is the first to turn around.

ARIANNA
(deadpan, loud)
Oh, look. Common Name's back from his spa week.

Laughter. The tension breaks. Raven (25) throws her arms around him. Harmony (26) hands him a coffee she's obviously been holding for him. Amond (26) nods once. From Amond, that's a ticker-tape parade.

On the wall TV, muted, CNN: "ROBERTSON CALLS FOR ASSASSINATION OF VENEZUELA'S CHAVEZ" and then "ISRAEL COMPLETES GAZA WITHDRAWAL." Esther (25) comes in last. She and Marc look at each other across the room. A small smile from her. A small one back.

MARC (V.O.)
They let me back in on a Tuesday.

3 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 4:52 AM

Six days later. The kitchen at an hour that isn't morning yet. Every light is on. Flour on every surface. Harmony, in her bonnet and an apron that says "KISS THE COOK (OR DON'T, I'M BUSY)," is folding batter. On the counter, an index card stained with forty years of butter: "LILLIAN'S SEVEN-UP POUND CAKE."

Raven sits at the island in a hoodie, staring at the little kitchen TV. CNN. A swirling satellite image fills the whole Gulf of Mexico. The chyron: "HURRICANE KATRINA: CATEGORY 4, 150 MPH. LANDFALL EXPECTED WITHIN HOURS."

RAVEN
(staring)
It's the size of the whole Gulf. Look at it. It's just... eating it.

HARMONY
(not looking up)
Is it going to Savannah?

RAVEN
No. Wrong side of Florida. (beat)
My cousin Tasha's in Gulfport.
Mississippi. With her two babies.
She wouldn't leave. She said the
last one, Ivan, didn't do
anything, and she can't afford a
hotel in Jackson for a week.

Marc comes down the stairs in scrubs, sniffing the air.

MARC
Why does my house smell like a
church basement?

HARMONY
It's Elxa's birthday.
Twenty-eight. My mama's pound
cake. Seven-Up. Nobody touches
it.

MARC
(reaching for a spatula
with batter on it)
I'm her brother. I have a
constitutional right to the...

HARMONY
(smacking his hand with
a wooden spoon, without
looking)
Constitution doesn't cover cake,
Common Name.

On the TV, the anchor's voice rises: "...the eye is now about sixty miles south of New Orleans. The Mayor issued the first mandatory evacuation in the city's history yesterday, but tens of thousands of residents remain, many of them without cars. About nine thousand people are sheltering in the Louisiana Superdome..."

All three of them stop and watch.

RAVEN
(quiet)
Without cars.

MARC (V.O.)
Everybody wants to be saved.
Nobody wants to be the one who
needs it.

Raven dials her phone. Listens. Hangs up. Dials again.

RAVEN
(to the phone, softly)
Come on, Tasha. Pick up.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 6:00 AM

Elxa (28) walks in with a ginger ale and a stack of charts. Her five interns are lined up, with Arianna on loan at the end. Before she can speak, they burst into the worst "Happy Birthday" ever sung in the borough of Queens: Harmony on key, everyone else in four different keys, Amond silently mouthing it.

ELXA
(holding up a hand)
Stop. Stop it. Stop.

ELXA
(sitting down)
I'm twenty-eight. I'm sixteen
weeks pregnant. I threw up in the
parking garage. If one more
person sings at me, I'm assigning
them to Mrs. Gutierrez's wound
vac.

HARMONY
(sweetly)
There's cake at lunch.

ELXA
(beat)
...What kind of cake?

HARMONY
Seven-Up pound cake.

ELXA
(beat, softening against her will)
Fine. You're all forgiven. (opening the charts) Assignments. It's going to be a long day, and half of you are going to spend it watching CNN. Don't. (beat) Bullock, Divine: Dr. Lowery. A twenty-six-year-old BRCA1 carrier requesting a prophylactic bilateral mastectomy. Lowery thinks she's too young and he'll tell her so. Try not to let him make her cry. Lowery has made four Chiefs of Surgery cry. (beat) Smilley, Ellison: Graves. Seventy-one-year-old woman who seized at church yesterday in South Jamaica. Big frontal mass on CT. She's from South Carolina and she has, quote, "a bag." I don't know what that means. Graves doesn't know what that means. Graves is already annoyed.

RAVEN
(perking up)
South Carolina where?

ELXA
(checking the chart)
St. Helena Island.

RAVEN
(beat)
Oh. I know what the bag is.

ELXA
Then you're my new favorite. (beat) Baker: Dr. Bullock Senior, CCU. Curtis Lemieux, forty-four, dilated cardiomyopathy, Status 1A on the transplant list, on a milrinone drip. He's from the Lower Ninth Ward in New Orleans.

Everyone glances at the TV. Amond doesn't.

AMOND
I'll handle it.

ELXA
Handle it gently. That's a man watching his hometown on TV with a heart that's barely pumping. (beat) Cummings: Gloria's pit. Go.

They scatter. Marc lingers.

MARC
(quiet)
Happy birthday, El.

ELXA
(just as quiet)
You came back. That's my present. (beat) Now go get yelled at by Lowery.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - ROOM 612 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 6:31 AM

DANIELLE PRYOR (26), sharp, composed, in a hospital gown with a leather planner on her lap, sits up in bed. A financial analyst's posture. Beside her, her fiancé, KEVIN HOLLIS (29), a big, gentle man in an MTA Bridges and Tunnels windbreaker, holds a cup of coffee he isn't drinking.

DR. ABRAHAM LOWERY (58), bow-legged, white-haired, half-moon glasses, stands at the foot of the bed reading the chart. Marc and Harmony flank him.

LOWERY
(reading)
Miss Pryor. BRCA1 mutation, deleterious, Myriad Genetics, November 2004. Mother: breast cancer at thirty-four, died at thirty-eight. Sister: breast cancer at twenty-nine, died at thirty-one. Clinical breast exam normal. Mammogram normal. (he looks up) You don't have cancer.

DANIELLE
(evenly)
Not yet.

LOWERY
You want me to take off two healthy breasts.

DANIELLE
I want you to take off two breasts that have about an eighty-five percent chance of killing me. (opening her planner) I read the papers, Dr. Lowery. Hartmann, Mayo Clinic, 1999. Rebbeck, Journal of Clinical Oncology, 2004. Bilateral prophylactic mastectomy reduces breast cancer risk in BRCA carriers by about ninety percent. (beat) I'd like the ninety percent.

Harmony glances at Marc: she's good.

LOWERY
(taking off his glasses)
Young lady, I have been doing breast surgery since 1979. Do you know how many twenty-six-year-olds I've done this operation on?

DANIELLE
How many?

LOWERY
None. (beat) Because twenty-six-year-olds get married and nurse babies and change their minds. Get MRIs every six months. Mammograms every year. Then come back at thirty-five, when you've had your children, and we'll talk.

DANIELLE
(beat)
My sister got mammograms every year. They found it at twenty-nine. At a stage three. (beat) She had a mammogram in March and a lump in September.

Silence. Kevin puts his hand on her knee. She doesn't take it.

KEVIN
(gently, to Lowery)
Doc. Is there a middle ground? Like... the screening thing. For a while. Till after the wedding. Till after we...

DANIELLE
(sharply)
Kevin.

KEVIN
I'm just asking. I'm allowed to ask.

LOWERY
(putting his glasses back on)
I'll order a pre-op breast MRI, and I want a psychiatric evaluation before I take a knife to anybody. Hospital policy for elective prophylactic surgery. (to Marc) Bullock, call Dr. Wise.

Marc freezes. Harmony notices.

MARC
(beat)
Dr. Wise. Of course.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 3 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 6:48 AM

MOTHER OZELLA RIVERS (71), small and ramrod straight in a hospital gown and a white head wrap, sits on the gurney like it's a throne. Around her neck, on a leather cord, hangs a small red flannel bag, tied off with string. On her lap is her purse, which she will not let go of.

Her daughter, BERNICE RIVERS-LANE (48), a nurse's aide at a Jamaica nursing home, still in her church clothes from yesterday, hovers. Esther and Raven enter with Graves (52), who has the CT films in his hand and the expression of a man who has already been told about the bag.

GRAVES
Mrs. Rivers. I'm Dr. Graves. I'm Chief of Neurosurgery. You have a tumor in the front of your brain, about the size of a plum. It's pressing on the brain, which is why you had a seizure at church.

OZELLA
(calm)
I know it. I been knowing it since Easter. Couldn't find the word for my grandbaby's name. Knew something was sitting on me.

GRAVES
It's almost certainly a meningioma. Usually benign. It needs to come out. This week. (beat) Before surgery, the nurses are going to need to take that off your neck.

OZELLA
(pleasantly)
No, sir.

GRAVES
Ma'am, nothing that isn't sterile goes into my operating room.

OZELLA
Then I reckon I don't go into your operating room.

Bernice closes her eyes. They've clearly had this argument already.

BERNICE
Mama. Please.

OZELLA
Bernice, I let them take my gallbladder in 1988 at Beaufort Memorial without it, and I almost died of the infection. I'm not doing that twice.

Graves looks at Esther with an expression that says "you deal with this." He hands her the films and leaves. Raven steps forward.

RAVEN
(gently)
Mother Rivers. Is that a mojo? From a root doctor?

Ozella looks at Raven for the first time. Really looks.

OZELLA
(narrowing her eyes)
What you know about a root doctor, girl?

RAVEN
My grandma had one in a jar over her kitchen door. In Savannah. Yamacraw Village. She said her mama got it from a man on Daufuskie Island.

OZELLA
(beat, slow smile)
Well. Look at that. A Geechee girl. (to Bernice) She's Geechee. (back to Raven) You comeyah or binyah?

RAVEN
(smiling)
Binyah, ma'am. Born there.

ESTHER
(lost)
I'm sorry, what are...

RAVEN
(to Esther, quietly)
"Comeyah" means you came here. "Binyah" means you been here. Gullah. (to Ozella) She's comeyah. From Boston.

OZELLA
(studying Esther)
Mm-hm. I can see that.

Ozella's eyes drop to Esther's collar. The chain, barely visible under her scrub top.

OZELLA
(quiet)
And you carrying something too, ain't you, baby? Round your neck. Heavier than mine.

Esther's hand goes to her collar on instinct.

ESTHER
(polite, closed)
It's just a necklace, Mrs. Rivers.

OZELLA
(gently)
Mm. A necklace with a ring on it. (beat) Whoever gave you that ain't done with you.

Esther goes very still. Raven looks at her.

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 7:08 AM

CURTIS LEMIEUX (44), gaunt and gray, a PICC line in his arm and a milrinone pump clicking beside him, sits propped up with a trombone case leaning in the corner of the room. The TV is on full volume. CNN: the eye wall slamming into Plaquemines Parish. A reporter is shouting into the wind somewhere on Canal Street.

Amond enters with the chart. Robert (49) is already there, standing at the window.

CURTIS
(not looking away from the TV)
That's Buras. They just hit Buras. (beat) My daddy used to take us fishing down there.

ROBERT
Mr. Lemieux, this is Dr. Baker. He'll be with you all day.

AMOND
Your ejection fraction is twelve percent. Your BNP is over three thousand. You're on milrinone because your heart can't keep up without it. You're Status 1A, the highest priority on the list. (beat) Agitation raises your heart rate, which raises your oxygen demand. You need to turn the TV down.

CURTIS
(finally looking at him)
My mama is in that. (pointing at the screen) Caffin Avenue. Lower Nine. Sixty-nine years old. Her and my brother Lionel. She said she rode out Betsy in '65 and she'll ride out this one. (beat) You want me to turn it DOWN?

Amond has no answer for that. Robert turns from the window.

ROBERT
(quietly)
Leave it on. (to Amond) Get him a phone that dials long distance. And a beta-blocker order he's not going to like.

On the TV: "7:10 AM EDT: KATRINA MAKES LANDFALL NEAR BURAS, LA. CATEGORY 3. WINDS 125 MPH."

CURTIS
(whispering at the screen)
Come on, Mama. Come on.

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - NURSES' STATION - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 7:26 AM

Arianna stands at the station with a chart, her cell phone buzzing again and again in her pocket. Gloria (53), Head ER Nurse, watches over the top of her reading glasses.

GLORIA
You going to answer that, or are you going to let it vibrate a hole in your scrubs?

ARIANNA
(checking it, jaw tight)
It's my brother. Gary. (beat) It's always my brother. Gary.

GLORIA
What's he want?

ARIANNA
Two hundred dollars. My mother got discharged from Methodist and he says there's no food in the house. (beat) Which there wasn't when I lived there either.

GLORIA
(beat)
Is it true?

ARIANNA
(bitter)
Sometimes it's true. That's the problem. You never know which time.

Gloria takes off her glasses.

GLORIA
My oldest boy was like that. Every Sunday, a different emergency. (beat) I bought groceries instead. Had them delivered from the Key Food. Can't smoke a pound of ground beef.

Arianna looks at her. Then actually laughs.

ARIANNA
Gloria. That's genius.

GLORIA
(putting her glasses back on)
That's motherhood. Same thing. (beat) Now. Bay 7. Kid with a nickel up his nose. Go be a surgeon.

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OB CLINIC - EXAM ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 7:48 AM

Elxa on the exam table, her scrub top pulled up over a small, firm curve. RUSSELL JEFFRIES (30) stands beside her holding a white paper bag from a bakery and a single sunflower. A TECH runs a Doppler wand over her belly. A fast, galloping whoosh fills the room: the baby's heartbeat.

TECH
One fifty-two. Strong.

Elxa lets out a breath she didn't know she was holding.

RUSSELL
(grinning)
That's the best birthday song you're getting today.

ELXA
You haven't heard the interns.

RUSSELL
(handing her the bag)
Croissant from the place on Vernon. Plain. No butter. I asked the girl, "What's the most boring thing you sell?"

ELXA
(taking it, touched)
You're the most boring thing I sell.

The tech prints the strip. Elxa looks at it: a little row of spikes.

RUSSELL
(gently)
The card's still in my wallet. The sealed one. You want to know yet?

ELXA
(beat)
February. (beat) I want one surprise in my life that nobody in my family planned.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - CORRIDOR - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 8:15 AM

Esther walks fast down the hall. Raven catches up.

RAVEN
Hey. What she said back there. About the ring.

ESTHER
(not slowing)
She's a seventy-one-year-old woman with a frontal lobe tumor. Frontal tumors cause disinhibition. Personality change. She's saying whatever comes into her head.

RAVEN
(beat)
She was right, though. About the ring.

Esther stops.

RAVEN
(holding up her hands)
Okay. Root doctors aren't magic. They're just people who pay attention. My grandma said that. (beat) Mother Rivers was paying attention.

Raven walks off. Esther stands there alone. She takes her RAZR out of her pocket. One new voicemail. A 617 number. She looks at it.

She puts the phone back in her pocket without listening.

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 9:20 AM

Curtis holds the hospital phone to his ear. Amond stands at the foot of the bed with the beta-blocker order in his hand, not giving it. On the TV: "STORM SURGE REPORTED IN LOWER NINTH WARD. INDUSTRIAL CANAL LEVEE MAY BE BREACHED."

CURTIS
(into the phone, desperate)
Lionel. Lionel, can you hear me? (beat) Where's Mama? (beat) The ATTIC? What you mean the attic?

Amond looks up.

CURTIS
(into the phone)
How high? (beat) Lionel, how high is the water? (beat) Over the porch? Over the... (beat) Get the hatchet. Daddy's hatchet, in the shed... it's in the house, okay, then get it, you get Mama up through the roof, you hear me, you get her up...

Silence. Curtis pulls the phone away from his ear and stares at it.

CURTIS
(quiet)
It cut out.

The cardiac monitor over the bed starts to chime. His heart rate climbs: 118. 126. 134.

AMOND
(stepping forward)
Mr. Lemieux. Breathe with me. In through your...

CURTIS
(dialing again, hands shaking)
My mama's in the attic, baby doctor. My mama's in the attic and the water's coming.

The monitor screams. A wide, ugly rhythm sweeps across the screen. V-tach.

AMOND
(shouting into the hall)
I need a crash cart in Bed 6! NOW!

Curtis's eyes roll back. The phone drops to the floor. A tiny voice on the other end: "Curtis? Curtis?"

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - CONTINUOUS
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 9:21 AM

Controlled chaos. Two CCU NURSES slam the crash cart against the bed. Amond rips Curtis's gown open and slaps on the pads. The monitor shows V-tach: wide, fast, no pulse.

AMOND
Pulseless V-tach. Charging to two hundred, biphasic. (beat) Clear!

Curtis's body jolts. Everyone looks at the monitor. A long, flat second. Then: a narrow, ragged rhythm. Sinus tachycardia. 128.

CCU NURSE
Pulse! Good pulse.

Amond lets out a breath. Robert comes through the curtain at a run, tie flying.

ROBERT
Talk.

AMOND
V-tach arrest at nine twenty-one. One shock at two hundred joules, back in sinus. He was on the phone with his brother. The water's in his mother's house. She's in the attic.

Robert looks at the phone on the floor. Picks it up. Dial tone.

ROBERT
(to the nurse)
Amiodarone, a hundred fifty milligram bolus, then the drip. (to Amond) His heart won't survive another one of those, Dr. Baker. Not on milrinone alone.

AMOND
He needs a bridge. A HeartMate. Before a donor heart shows up. If one shows up.

ROBERT
(nodding)
Today.

Curtis's eyes flutter open. He's groggy, gray, but awake.

CURTIS
(hoarse)
What happened?

ROBERT
Your heart stopped, Mr. Lemieux. Dr. Baker restarted it. (beat) It's going to happen again unless we put in a pump. A left ventricular assist device. It does the work your heart can't, until we find you a new one.

CURTIS
(looking for the phone)
Where's the phone? Where's my... Lionel was talking.

AMOND
(beat)
The line's dead.

CURTIS
(struggling to sit up)
Then call it back.

ROBERT
Mr. Lemieux...

CURTIS
(fierce, through the oxygen mask)
I'm not going to sleep. I'm not going under, I'm not going on no pump, I'm not doing NOTHING till somebody tells me my mama got out of that attic. (beat) You hear me, Doc?

Robert and Amond exchange a look.

AMOND
(quiet)
I'll keep calling.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - ROOM 612 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 9:48 AM

Dr. Wise sits in the chair beside Danielle's bed with a clipboard. Kevin has been sent to get coffee. Marc stands awkwardly by the door.

DR. WISE
(without turning around)
Dr. Bullock. Small hospital.

MARC
(beat)
Yes, ma... Yes.

DR. WISE
(to Danielle)
Miss Pryor. Some people who ask for this surgery are frightened out of their minds. Some are depressed. A few are trying to punish their own bodies for something. (beat) Which one are you?

DANIELLE
(calmly)
None of them. I'm doing math.

DR. WISE
Show me the math.

DANIELLE
My mother was diagnosed at thirty-four. My sister at twenty-nine. Every generation in my family, it comes five years sooner. (beat) I'm twenty-six, Dr. Wise. If I wait until thirty-five like Dr. Lowery wants, I'm betting my life that I'm the one woman in my family it skips.

DR. WISE
And your fiancé?

DANIELLE
(beat, the first crack)
Kevin wants babies. I want babies. Kevin wants me to nurse them. His mother nursed him. Everybody in his family nursed. (beat) I can't nurse a baby if I'm dead.

DR. WISE
Have you said that to him? In those words?

DANIELLE
(looking at her planner)
...Not in those words.

DR. WISE
(writing)
Then that's tonight's homework. Not mine. (beat) I'm clearing you. You are the sanest person on this floor. (beat, glancing at Marc) And that's a competitive category.

Marc almost smiles.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - FAMILY LOUNGE - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 10:05 AM

Kevin sits with two cold coffees, watching the CNN feed on the lounge TV. The Superdome, part of its roof peeled open. Marc comes in and sits beside him.

MARC
Dr. Wise cleared her.

KEVIN
(nodding slowly)
'Course she did. Dani passes every test. Dani passed CFA Level One on the first try. Dani's never failed anything in her life.

He sets down the coffee.

KEVIN
You want to know the real thing? It's not the nursing. I said that because it sounds like a reason. (beat) I'm scared she's doing this because she already thinks she's dead. Like her mama and Kia are waiting for her, and she's just... getting ready.

MARC
(beat)
I don't think that's what it is.

KEVIN
You don't know her.

MARC
No. But I know what it looks like when somebody's getting ready to die. I sat with a ten-year-old for a week this month while he got ready. (beat) That's not her. She brought a planner. People who are getting ready to die don't bring a planner, Kevin. She's not getting ready to die. She's trying to be alive for something.

KEVIN
(quiet)
For what?

MARC
(beat)
Ask her. (beat) I think it's you. And the babies she doesn't have yet.

Kevin looks at him. Then at the TV, where a man is wading through chest-high water with a child on his shoulders.

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEUROSURGERY FLOOR - ROOM 508 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 10:30 AM

Ozella sits up in bed, her mojo bag still around her neck, a Bible open on her lap. Bernice is asleep in the chair. Graves stands at the bedside with the MRI. Esther and Raven are with him.

GRAVES
Left frontal convexity meningioma. Four point eight centimeters. It's sitting on top of the brain, not inside it, which is good news. I expect to get all of it. Surgery at one o'clock. (beat) Which brings us back to the bag.

OZELLA
(not looking up from her Bible)
It brings us right back.

GRAVES
Mrs. Rivers, I've operated in four countries. I've operated in a tent in Kosovo. I've never let anything unsterile within three feet of an open skull.

OZELLA
And I never let nobody cut my head open. So we both doing something new today.

Graves opens his mouth. Raven steps in.

RAVEN
Dr. Graves. What if it isn't in the field?

GRAVES
(impatient)
Everything above the waist is in the field, Dr. Ellison.

RAVEN
(carefully)
Her foot isn't. (beat) Her feet will be under the drapes at the far end of the table, nowhere near you. If we put the mojo in a clean plastic bag and tuck it in her sock, it stays with her the whole time. And it never gets anywhere near your field.

Silence. Esther looks at Raven, impressed. Graves looks at Ozella's feet, then at the bag, then at Raven.

GRAVES
(finally)
If it's at the other end of the table, under two layers of drape, outside my sterile field, she can bring a rooster for all I care.

OZELLA
(closing her Bible, satisfied)
Don't need no rooster. (to Raven) My grandmama kept hers in her shoe. You knew that, didn't you?

RAVEN
(smiling)
My grandma did too.

GRAVES
(leaving)
One o'clock. And Dr. Ellison? (beat) Good.

He goes. Raven glows. Ozella pats the bed beside her.

OZELLA
Sit down, Geechee girl. Tell me about your grandmama.

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL C - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 10:52 AM

Esther, alone on the landing. She takes out her RAZR. Listens to the voicemail. We hear it.

CLAYTON (V.O.)
(on the phone, a smooth Boston baritone, tired)
Es. It's me. (beat) I know you're not going to call me back. You haven't called back since April. (beat) I'm coming to New York. Next week. Columbia offered me the maternal-fetal medicine fellowship, and I said yes. (beat) We're still married, Esther. Whatever you think I did, whatever you saw, we're still married, and you can't hide on a boat in Queens forever. (beat) I'll call when I land. Please pick up.

A beep. "To delete this message, press seven. To save it, press nine."

Esther's thumb hovers over the seven. She stares at it for a long moment.

She presses nine.

ESTHER
(to herself, barely audible)
Not yet.

She tucks the ring back under her collar and walks up the stairs.

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - BAY 7 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 11:10 AM

A furious five-year-old boy, DEVONTE, sits on his mother's lap. Arianna holds an alligator forceps and a headlamp. Kendra Wallace (25) is assisting.

ARIANNA
(to Devonte)
Okay, Spider-Man. On three, you're going to blow your nose like a dragon. One. Two...

She pinches the open nostril. He blows. A nickel shoots out of his nose and pings off her headlamp.

ARIANNA
(catching it, deadpan)
Five cents. You're rich.

The mother laughs. Devonte, offended, holds out his hand. Arianna gives him the nickel. They go. Kendra cleans up the tray.

KENDRA
(casual, too casual)
So. Bullock. (beat) Deb says his grandfather's rich. Like, rich rich. Somebody saw a Town Car at the loading dock the day the astronaut kid died.

Arianna doesn't miss a beat. She strips off her gloves.

ARIANNA
His grandfather drove a bus in D.C. Metrobus. For thirty years. He died in 1999. (beat) You think the bus driver's grandson lives in Hunters Point because he's rich? He's got four roommates, Kendra.

ARIANNA
The Town Car was probably Bassett. Bassett takes Town Cars to the bathroom.

KENDRA
(laughing)
Okay. Okay. (beat) You two are friends now? You and Bullock?

ARIANNA
(walking off)
I don't have friends. I have people I tolerate.

She steps into the hallway and pulls out her phone. Dials a number.

ARIANNA
(into the phone)
Hi. Key Food on Grant Street, Gary, Indiana? (beat) I'd like to place a delivery order. Over the phone. With a credit card. (beat) Ground beef, rice, eggs, milk, bread, cereal, the big box of Tide, and... (she softens a little) ...Honey Nut Cheerios. My brother likes Honey Nut Cheerios.

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - DOCTORS' LOUNGE - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 11:34 AM

Harmony is at the wall phone, writing on her palm with a ballpoint pen. On the TV in the corner: "KATRINA MAKES SECOND LANDFALL, LA-MS BORDER. BILOXI, GULFPORT 'DEVASTATED.'"

HARMONY
(into the phone)
Daddy, it's six minutes. They X-ray you, you go home. (beat) No, I made it after Labor Day like you said. Tuesday, September sixth, ten-thirty. Pulmonary clinic, second floor. I'll walk you over myself. (beat) Daddy, I can hear you coughing through the phone.

LILLIAN (V.O.)
(picking up the extension, on the phone)
Harmony, he's been coughing like that since July and he won't let me say a word.

HOWARD (V.O.)
(on the phone)
Lil, get off the extension.

LILLIAN (V.O.)
I'm not getting off nothing. Howard Divine, you're going to that appointment if I have to drive the Q4 bus there myself.

She hangs up. Looks at the numbers on her palm: "9/6 10:30." Raven walks in looking at her phone, pale.

HARMONY
Tasha?

RAVEN
(shaking her head)
All circuits are busy. Every time. (beat) They said on the news Gulfport's gone. The whole beachfront. Just... gone.

Harmony takes her hand. They watch the TV together.

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - RADIOLOGY - BREAST MRI READING ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 12:08 PM

A dark room lit only by monitors. DR. CYNTHIA BRAXTON (45), breast radiologist, scrolls through gray-and-white slices. Lowery stands behind her with his arms crossed. Marc and Harmony are behind him.

DR. BRAXTON
Right breast is clean. (scrolling) Left breast, upper outer quadrant. (she stops) There.

A small, bright, irregular spot on the screen. Nine millimeters of white against the gray.

DR. BRAXTON
Irregular margins. Rapid enhancement, washout on the delayed images. (beat) That's not a cyst, Abe. I'd call it BI-RADS five.

Nobody says anything. Harmony puts her hand over her mouth.

MARC
(quiet)
BI-RADS five means...

LOWERY
(staring at the screen)
It means highly suggestive of malignancy. (beat) It means that the young lady was right, and I was wrong. (beat) She had a normal mammogram in June.

DR. BRAXTON
Dense breasts at twenty-six. Mammograms miss half of these in young BRCA carriers. That's why we do MRI.

Lowery takes off his half-moon glasses. For the first time, he looks every one of his fifty-eight years.

LOWERY
(quiet)
It's already there.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - ROOM 612 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 12:24 PM

Lowery sits on the edge of Danielle's bed. Not standing at the foot of it this time. Kevin stands at the window. Marc and Harmony by the door.

LOWERY
Miss Pryor. Your MRI found a nine-millimeter mass in your left breast. It looks like cancer. We'll need a biopsy to be certain, and I want it done this afternoon.

Danielle doesn't react. She opens her planner. Picks up her pen. Puts it down again.

DANIELLE
(very calm)
Okay. (beat) Okay.

KEVIN
(turning from the window)
Dani.

DANIELLE
(still calm, too calm)
It's small. Nine millimeters is small. That's... stage one, probably, if the nodes are clean. Stage one BRCA1 triple-negative, the five-year survival is...

Her voice catches on the number. She stops. Her hand is shaking. The pen rolls off the planner and onto the floor.

Marc picks it up. Holds it out to her. She doesn't take it.

DANIELLE
(to nobody)
I was going to beat it. That was the whole point. I was going to be the first one who beat it before it started.

She breaks. Not loudly: a small, tight sound, like something snapping. Kevin is across the room in two steps, on the bed, holding her. She lets him.

LOWERY
(quiet, to Danielle)
Young lady. I've been doing this since 1979, and I've got something to say that I don't say often. (beat) I was wrong. If I'd done what you asked this morning, I'd have found this in the specimen tomorrow. You found it yourself. You saved your own life by not listening to me.

Danielle looks at him over Kevin's shoulder.

LOWERY
(standing, putting his glasses back on)
Nine millimeters, caught on a screening MRI, in a twenty-six-year-old who's going to do every single thing right. (beat) That's not a death sentence. That's a schedule. And I hear you're very good with schedules.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 12:45 PM

Lunch. Harmony's Seven-Up pound cake sits on the table with a single candle in it. Elxa sits in front of it. Around her: Russell, the interns, Gloria, Deb Lyons and Kendra. The TV is muted on CNN. Nobody's watching it, and everybody's watching it.

HARMONY
(lighting the candle)
Make a wish. A good one.

ELXA
(looking at the TV, then at the cake)
I wish everybody's mama gets out of the attic.

Silence. Even Arianna doesn't have a comeback. Elxa blows out the candle. Russell kisses her temple.

The door opens. Natasha (47), in her white coat, carrying a small, flat, velvet box. Everyone straightens up. The Chief.

NATASHA
(lightly)
As you were. I'm not here as anybody's Chief. (to Elxa) I'm here as somebody's mother. Briefly. I have a board call at one.

She hands Elxa the box. Elxa opens it. A strand of pearls, old and creamy, with a small gold clasp.

ELXA
(quietly)
Mama. These are Grandma Joan's.

NATASHA
She put them on me the morning of my wedding. I put them on you the morning of yours. (beat) Somebody in this family is going to wear them for a third generation, and I'm told it'll be February.

Elxa can't speak. Natasha clasps them around her neck, over her scrubs. Raven leans to Harmony.

RAVEN
(whispering)
Are those real?

HARMONY
(whispering)
Raven.

Natasha's cell rings. She checks it and hands it to Elxa.

NATASHA
Your sister.

ELXA
(into the phone)
Gracie? (beat, laughing) No, you can't sing, I've been sung at enough. (beat) How's Boston? (beat) First day of what? (beat, to the room) She says it's her first day of surgery rotation at Mass General and a resident already called her "the Bullock girl."

MARC
(calling out)
Tell her to tell him she's the GOOD Bullock!

ELXA
(into the phone)
Marc says you're the good Bullock. (beat) She says, "Obviously."

Laughter. Natasha watches Marc across the room. Marc meets her eyes. Something passes between them.

NATASHA
(passing him on the way out, low)
You look like a man about to do something.

MARC
(equally low)
I'm going to tell her, Mama. Esther. Tonight.

Natasha stops for half a second. Then she keeps walking.

NATASHA
(over her shoulder, low)
Dinner's at eight-thirty. We'll talk.

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 4 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 1:34 PM

Ozella on the table, her head shaved on one side and pinned in a Mayfield clamp. Graves at the microscope, Esther across from him. Raven is the circulating intern, standing at the foot of the table, where a small bump shows under the drapes at the far end: the mojo in

Ozella's sock.

GRAVES
(working)
Dura's open. There she is. (beat) Dr. Smilley, see how it's pushing the brain down and back? Not invading. Pushing. Like a houseguest that won't leave.

ESTHER
(watching through the side scope)
Clean plane.

GRAVES
Clean plane. Bipolar. (beat) Dr. Ellison. How's our friend at the other end of the table?

RAVEN
(checking the bump under the drapes)
Still in her sock, sir. Outside your field.

GRAVES
(dry)
Wonderful. (to Esther) Your hands are steady today, Dr. Smilley.

ESTHER
Thank you.

GRAVES
(not looking up)
They weren't last Tuesday. Or the Tuesday before that. (beat) Whatever you're carrying around your neck, leave it outside my OR. Seems everybody in this room has something in their sock today.

Esther's eyes flick up at him over her mask. Graves keeps working.

GRAVES
(beat)
My grandmother kept a horseshoe over the door in Beaufort. (beat) Nobody tell anyone I said that.

Raven grins under her mask.

GRAVES
Tumor's out. In one piece. Simpson grade one. (beat) Somebody tell Mrs. Rivers her rooster can stay home.

23 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 2:15 PM

Curtis is awake, gray and sweating, refusing. On TV: "NEW ORLEANS: 'WATER IS RISING'; REPORTS OF PEOPLE ON ROOFTOPS IN LOWER NINTH WARD." Amond sits beside the bed with the phone, hitting redial. Busy signal. Redial. Busy signal. His beeper has gone off three times. He has ignored it three times.

CURTIS
(watching him)
How many times is that?

AMOND
Sixty-one.

CURTIS
Your doctor man's going to fire you, baby doctor.

AMOND
He told me to do this.

Redial. Busy signal.

CURTIS
(beat)
You got a mama?

AMOND
In Los Angeles. She remarried an orthodontist.

CURTIS
Your daddy?

Amond's thumb stops over the redial button.

AMOND
(beat, flat)
He died when I was nine. Car crash on Stocker Street. We were coming home from a Lakers game. (beat) I was in the back seat. I held his hand until the ambulance came. It took eleven minutes.

Curtis turns from the TV to look at him.

AMOND
(still flat, but barely)
There was nothing anybody could do. That's what they told my mother. Nothing anybody could do. (beat) That's not true for you, Mr. Lemieux. There's something we can do. There's a pump. And you're refusing it because you can't reach your mother. (beat) I couldn't do anything for mine. Let me do something for yours.

A long silence. On the TV, a helicopter shot of a roof in the Ninth Ward. Three people waving a white sheet.

CURTIS
(quiet)
You keep calling.

AMOND
(beat)
I'll keep calling.

CURTIS
(closing his eyes)
Okay, baby doctor. Okay. Go get your pump.

Amond stands up. Robert is in the doorway. He's been there a while.

ROBERT
(quiet)
OR Two at four. (beat) Dr. Baker. You'll be first assist.

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ON-CALL ROOM 2 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 2:40 PM

Elxa lies on the bottom bunk with her feet up, Grandma Joan's pearls still on over her scrubs. Marc sits on the floor with his back against the bunk.

ELXA
You told Mama.

MARC
I told Mama I'm going to tell Esther. Mama said "dinner." Which means "no."

ELXA
Mama said "we'll talk," which for Mama is a sonnet. (beat) Marc, why tonight?

MARC
(beat)
Because she told me not to tell her drunk. And I'm not drunk. (beat) And because all day, everybody in this hospital's been waiting to be saved, and nobody's asking. A woman in 612 saved her own life by asking for something nobody wanted to give her. (beat) I don't want Esther finding out from Kendra at the nurses' station. Or from a Town Car.

Elxa sits straight up.

ELXA
Oh. Oh. Marc. Give me your hand.

MARC
(alarmed, on his knees)
What? What's wrong? Is it...

She grabs his hand and presses it flat against the side of her belly. They both hold very still. A long beat.

MARC
(whispering)
I don't feel anything.

ELXA
(eyes wet, laughing)
You can't. Not from the outside, not for another month. (beat) But I can. Right now. That's the first time. On my birthday. (beat) Like popcorn. Everybody said it feels like popcorn.

Marc doesn't move his hand anyway. His face is completely open, the face of a man who has wanted exactly this, a family, his whole life.

MARC
(to the belly, whispering)
Hey. It's your uncle. I'm going to be so much fun. Your mom's going to hate it.

ELXA
(softly)
Go tell her, Marc. (beat) Mama doesn't get a vote on who you love. Neither does Granddaddy. (beat) This baby's going to grow up with a family that tells each other the truth. Start with you.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - ROOM 612 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 4:20 PM

The core biopsy dressing is taped to Danielle's left side. Lowery holds a single sheet of paper: a rush pathology read. Kevin holds Danielle's hand. Marc and Harmony are present.

LOWERY
Invasive ductal carcinoma. Grade three. Nine millimeters. Receptor studies will take a few days, but in a BRCA1 carrier, we expect triple negative. (beat) Here's my recommendation. Bilateral mastectomy. Both sides, as you asked this morning. A sentinel lymph node biopsy on the left. Tissue expanders for reconstruction, if you want them. Tomorrow at seven-thirty a.m., first case. And then, probably, chemotherapy.

DANIELLE
(steady now)
Tomorrow.

LOWERY
Tomorrow. I'm not waiting on this one.

DANIELLE
(beat)
Okay. Yes. All of it. (to Kevin) Kevin, I'm going to lose my hair. Right before the wedding. October fifteenth. I already paid the deposit at Terrace on the Park...

KEVIN
(cutting her off)
Then don't wait till October.

DANIELLE
What?

KEVIN
(standing up, the big gentle man suddenly very sure)
Marry me today. Tonight. Before they take anything. (beat) I don't care about Terrace on the Park. I don't care about the deposit. I don't want you going into that operating room tomorrow as my fiancée. I want you going in as my wife.

Danielle stares at him.

DANIELLE
(beat)
Kevin, that's... we don't have a license. There's a twenty-four-hour waiting period in New York. The City Clerk closed at four. That's not even legal.

KEVIN
(turning to Marc)
Doc. Is there a chapel in this place?

Everyone looks at Marc. Lowery raises an eyebrow. Harmony already knows exactly what's about to happen.

MARC
(beat, slow grin)
Give me two hours.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 2 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 4:48 PM

Curtis's chest is open, his huge, baggy, failing heart barely moving under the lights. Robert operates. Amond is first assist. On a side table sits the HeartMate XVE: a titanium pump the size of a hockey puck, with its driveline coiled beside it.

ROBERT
Look at it, Dr. Baker. Twelve percent. That ventricle is a balloon. (beat) Coring knife.

AMOND
(handing it over)
Apical cuff is sewn in.

Robert cores the apex of the heart. Precise, fast. The circulating nurse, NURSE PAULINE GREER (40), stands by the wall phone with a list of numbers.

NURSE GREER
(into the phone, then hanging up)
Still all circuits busy, Dr. Baker. Fourth try.

AMOND
(not looking up)
Try the brother's cell again in fifteen. Then the church. Then the Red Cross line.

ROBERT
(beat)
Inflow cannula. (beat) Now. You're going to sew the outflow graft to the ascending aorta. I'll hold.

Amond takes the needle driver. His hands are steady. Robert watches every stitch.

ROBERT
(quietly, while Amond sews)
I couldn't get to my father either. 1999. Metrobus depot in D.C., heart attack in the drivers' lounge. I was in an OR in Queens, replacing somebody else's father's valve. (beat) By the time I got the page, it was over.

Amond's hands keep moving. But he hears every word.

ROBERT
(beat)
You don't get them all back, Dr. Baker. But today, you get to give somebody's mother a son with a pulse. That counts. (beat) De-air the pump. Coming off bypass.

The HeartMate whirs to life. A steady mechanical hum. The monitor shows the pump flow: 5.1 liters per minute.

AMOND
(staring at it)
Five point one.

ROBERT
(pulling down his mask)
Good. (beat) Close him, Dr. Baker. Then go make your phone calls.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHAPLAIN'S OFFICE - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 5:12 PM

A cramped office with a crucifix, a menorah, a framed Arabic calligraphy and a stack of hymnals. REV. WENDELL AMOS (61), the hospital chaplain, in a clerical collar and Kangol, looks at Marc over a cup of tea.

REV. AMOS
(patiently)
Dr. Bullock. They have no license.

MARC
They'll have one Thursday. Kevin's taking the day off. They'll go down to Borough Hall with a copy of the vows and get it stamped. (beat) But tonight is the night before she loses both her breasts, Reverend. She wants to go into surgery as somebody's wife.

REV. AMOS
A wedding without a license isn't a legal marriage in the State of New York.

MARC
I didn't ask you to marry them in the State of New York. I asked you to marry them in front of God. (beat) God doesn't have business hours.

Rev. Amos sets down his tea.

MARC
It's been a long day for everybody, Reverend. I'd like one thing in it to go right.

Rev. Amos looks at him for a long moment. Then stands and takes down a worn white stole from a hook.

REV. AMOS
(sighing, smiling)
Seven-thirty. And somebody had better bring flowers. I'm not marrying anybody in front of the vending machines.

Marc is already dialing.

MARC
(into the phone)
Monty. It's me. (beat) No, I'm not drunk. I need sparkling cider, a case, and whatever flowers they've got at the Korean deli on Vernon. (beat) It's a wedding. (beat) Yes, a real one. Mostly.

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEURO ICU - BED 3 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 6:08 PM

Ozella, bandaged, extubated, awake. Bernice holds her hand, crying with relief. Raven stands at the foot of the bed holding a small plastic bag with the red flannel mojo inside.

RAVEN
(holding it up)
Never left your sock, Mother Rivers. Dr. Graves even asked about it during surgery.

OZELLA
(hoarse)
That man asked about my bag?

RAVEN
(grinning)
He asked if it was happy.

OZELLA
(closing her eyes, smiling)
Hm. Tell him it's happy. (beat, eyes opening) Bernice. Say my grandbaby's name.

BERNICE
(confused)
Mama?

OZELLA
Just say it.

BERNICE
...Desmond.

OZELLA
(slowly, carefully)
Des. Mond. (beat, a smile spreading) Desmond. (beat) Been five months I couldn't find that name. It's back.

Bernice breaks down. Raven turns away, wiping her eyes. Esther comes in with a chart and stops when she sees them.

OZELLA
(seeing Esther)
There go Boston.

ESTHER
(smiling)
How are you feeling, Mrs. Rivers?

OZELLA
Like somebody took a plum out of my head. (beat) Come here, baby.

Esther comes closer. Ozella reaches up and taps the chain at Esther's collarbone with one finger.

OZELLA
(quiet, only for Esther)
I ain't no prophet. I'm an old woman who pays attention. (beat) That tall boy who keeps walking past this room pretending he ain't looking for you? He's carrying something too. Got it all over his face. (beat) Somebody got to put theirs down first. Don't matter who. Just matters that somebody does.

Esther looks at her for a long beat. Then gently takes the old woman's hand off her collar and holds it.

ESTHER
(softly)
Get some rest, Mother Rivers.

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 7:05 PM

Curtis, intubated and sedated, the HeartMate humming softly inside him and the driveline taped to his abdomen. His color is already better. Amond, still in his OR cap, sits beside the bed with the phone, the list of numbers on his knee. On the TV, muted: "LEVEE BREACHES REPORTED; 'SIGNIFICANT FLOODING' IN NEW ORLEANS."

Amond dials. Listens.

RECORDING (V.O.)
(over the phone)
We're sorry. All circuits are busy. Please try your call again later.

He hangs up. Writes a tick mark on the list: there are dozens. He dials again.

AMOND
(quietly, to the sleeping Curtis)
Seventy-four.

30 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - JACKSON AVENUE ENTRANCE - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 7:16 PM

Monty (42) climbs out of a double-parked Lincoln with a case of Martinelli's on one shoulder and three buckets of deli flowers in his other arm. Big Ray (45), all six-foot-seven of him, steps into his path at the door.

BIG RAY
Visiting hours end at eight, sir.

MONTY
(peering up at him)
I'm not visiting. I'm catering.

BIG RAY
(looking at the flowers)
Catering what?

MONTY
A wedding. Doc Bullock's orders. Chapel, seven-thirty. (beat) He said you'd give me trouble. He said tell you, quote, "Ray, it's the good kind of rule-breaking."

Big Ray looks at the flowers. At the cider. At Monty. A very long beat.

BIG RAY
(taking a bucket of flowers)
Elevator's on the left. (beat) I'm coming to the wedding.

31 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHAPEL - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 7:34 PM

A small non-denominational chapel with six pews and a stained-glass window of a dove over the East River. Tonight it's packed. Monty's deli flowers, roses and carnations and one very confused sunflower, are stuffed into IV-pole vases. A case of Martinelli's sparkling cider sits on a cart.

In the pews: Kevin's mother, MRS. GLADYS HOLLIS (57), who came straight from Canarsie in her church hat, and his two brothers. Mrs. Delgado and the Rosary group. Kendra, Deb, Gloria. Harmony, Raven, Arianna. Elxa and Russell. Lowery sits in the front row in his white coat. Marc stands by the door.

Rev. Amos stands at the front in his white stole. Kevin waits beside him in a borrowed tie from the gift shop, sweating.

The doors open. Danielle comes in, in a wheelchair, in her hospital gown with a white cardigan over it and a veil Raven made out of surgical tulle. The biopsy dressing is visible at her side. She's holding a bouquet of three roses.

Harmony stands. Without a microphone or accompaniment, she begins to sing: Stevie Wonder's "Ribbon in the Sky." Her voice fills the little room. Gladys Hollis grabs her son's other hand.

Danielle stops the wheelchair halfway up the aisle. She looks at the front row.

DANIELLE
(to Lowery)
Dr. Lowery. (beat) My father's been gone since I was four. Would you...?

Lowery stares at her. Then he stands up slowly, takes off his half-moon glasses, puts them in his pocket and takes the handles of the wheelchair. He wheels her the rest of the way. His jaw is working.

REV. AMOS
(opening his book)
Dearly beloved. We are gathered here, on a hard day, in a hard week, to witness something easy. Two people who love each other, saying so. (beat) Kevin. I'm told you have something to say.

KEVIN
(unfolding a napkin with writing on it, then putting it away)
I wrote it down. I'm not going to read it. (beat) Dani. This morning I asked you to wait. To keep them. I said it was about nursing, about babies, about the wedding. (beat) It was about me. I was scared. (beat) I'm not scared anymore. I want you. Not your body. You. Every version. Bald. Flat. Tired. Mad at me about the dishes. (beat) For better, for worse, for sickness and in health, and for every scan you ever have to sit through, I'm going to be in the chair next to you. With coffee. Hot coffee this time.

Laughter through tears.

DANIELLE
(taking a breath)
I had a whole thing planned. With bullet points. (beat) Kevin. Everybody in my family died waiting for it to come. I'm not waiting. And you're not waiting with me. You're running with me. (beat) I'm not dying. I'm deciding. And I decide you.

REV. AMOS
(smiling)
Then by the authority vested in me by Almighty God, and by the State of New York as of Thursday, when you go to Borough Hall, I pronounce you husband and wife. (beat) You may kiss the bride.

Kevin leans down and kisses her. The chapel erupts. Mrs. Delgado's Rosary group cheers like it's the World Series. Gloria cries openly. Arianna, in the back pew, very definitely does not cry.

Marc stands at the back, watching. Esther slips in beside him in the doorway. Neither of them says anything. Her shoulder touches his arm.

ESTHER
(quiet)
You did this.

MARC
(quiet)
She did this. I just moved a Rosary group.

He checks his watch: 7:51. He looks at her.

MARC
I have to go to my sister's birthday dinner. (beat) Are you going to be home tonight? On the boat?

ESTHER
(beat)
After eleven.

MARC
Can I come by? (beat) Sober.

Esther looks at him for a long moment. She understands exactly what he's asking.

ESTHER
(softly)
Yes.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

32 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - RIVERSIDE DRIVE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 8:44 PM

A long mahogany table set for six, with one place empty. Through the bay window, the Hudson is dark and New Jersey glitters on the far bank. Natasha, Elxa (in Grandma Joan's pearls), Russell and Marc eat smothered chicken and greens. In the center of the table is a massive arrangement of white peonies, impossible in August.

A cream card leans against the vase. One letter, in fountain pen: "V."

ELXA
(touching the card)
He called this morning. At six. He sang the whole thing. All the verses.

MARC
(smiling)
He does the harmony part on "and many more."

ELXA
He did the harmony part.

Natasha's BlackBerry buzzes. She reads it.

NATASHA
Your father. The LVAD's in, the pump's running and he's sitting with Dr. Baker. He says start without him. (beat) We already started without him.

ELXA
(looking at the empty chair)
He never misses a birthday.

NATASHA
(gently)
He's not missing it. He's sitting with a man whose mother is on a roof in New Orleans. (beat) That's the man I married. I believe I've mentioned it.

Elxa softens.

33 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - FRONT STOOP - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 10:02 PM

Riverside Drive is quiet. Marc sits on the brownstone's stoop, jacket over his arm. The door opens behind him. Natasha comes out with two cups of tea and sits beside him. A long silence. A taxi goes by.

NATASHA
You're going to Flushing Bay.

MARC
Yes.

NATASHA
(beat)
You know the policy, Marc. Your grandfather's security people wrote it before you were born. The grandchildren's faces, names, schools, all of it. Need to know.

MARC
I know the policy, Mama. I've lived inside the policy my whole life. (beat) She needs to know.

NATASHA
Does she? (beat) Or do you need to tell her?

MARC
(beat)
Both. (beat) She told me not to tell her drunk. Because she wanted it to be a choice. Not an accident. Not a crash-out. (beat) Nobody's ever wanted it to be my choice before.

Natasha looks at her son. Then at the river.

NATASHA
(quiet)
I told your father on our second date. Fall of 1976. A diner on Georgia Avenue, the weekend I came down from Radcliffe for Howard's homecoming. (beat) I said "My father is Victor Donohue." He said "Who?"

Marc laughs. Natasha smiles.

NATASHA
He really didn't know. He'd grown up in D.C. on a bus driver's salary. He'd never read a medical journal that didn't come from the public library. (beat) It's the only reason I married him. Because he said "who."

MARC
Esther's going to know who.

NATASHA
(beat)
Yes. She's a Harvard M.D. She'll know exactly who. (beat) And then you'll find out what she does with it. That's the part nobody can protect you from, baby. Not the policy. Not your grandfather. Not me.

She stands. Kisses the top of his head the way she did when he was small.

NATASHA
Your grandfather said you'd do this. This morning, on the phone with Elxa, he asked me if you'd told the Boston girl yet. (beat) I said "Not yet." He said, "He will. He's the one I picked, Tasha. He'll do it right."

She goes inside. Marc sits on the stoop, holding his tea, his eyes wet.

34 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 9:38 PM

The ER on a slow night. Arianna, on a double, sits at the station eating the last slice of Elxa's pound cake off a paper towel. Her phone buzzes. She answers without looking.

ARIANNA
(into the phone)
Cummings.

AHMAD (V.O.)
(on the phone, twenty, indignant)
Ari. A man from the Key Food just knocked on the door with nine bags of groceries.

ARIANNA
(chewing)
Mm-hm.

AHMAD (V.O.)
I asked you for two hundred dollars.

ARIANNA
And now you have two hundred dollars' worth of groceries. (beat) Is Mama eating?

AHMAD (V.O.)
(beat, quieter)
...She made eggs. First time since she got home. (beat) She asked who sent it. I said you. (beat) She said, "My Ari?"

Arianna stops chewing.

ARIANNA
(carefully)
She said my name?

AHMAD (V.O.)
She said your name. (beat) And Ari? You sent Honey Nut Cheerios.

ARIANNA
(looking down)
Yeah, well. They were on sale.

AHMAD (V.O.)
(laughing)
No they weren't.

Gloria, passing behind her with a chart, catches the look on Arianna's face. Doesn't say a word. Just squeezes her shoulder on the way by.

35 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 10:20 PM

Curtis sleeps, sedated. Amond is still in the chair, the phone in his lap, the list full of tick marks. Robert sits in the second chair, jacket off, sleeves rolled up. Both of them watching the muted CNN feed: a nighttime shot of the city, black water everywhere, a few flashlights on rooftops.

ROBERT
You should go home.

AMOND
I told him I'd keep calling.

ROBERT
(beat)
How many?

AMOND
Ninety-three.

Robert holds out his hand. Amond looks at it, confused.

ROBERT
The phone, Dr. Baker. (beat) I'll take the next hundred. You sleep in that chair. When you wake up, you take the hundred after that.

Amond hands him the phone. Robert dials. Listens. Busy. Hangs up. Writes a tick on the list in his own neat handwriting.

ROBERT
(dialing again)
Ninety-four.

Amond leans his head back against the wall. He watches his mentor dial a phone number for a stranger's mother.

AMOND
(eyes closing)
My birthday's in February. (beat) Nobody's ever sat with me on one.

ROBERT
(not looking at him, dialing)
Noted, Dr. Baker. Go to sleep.

36 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 10:41 PM

Raven sits on the stoop in her scrubs with her phone in both hands. Harmony comes out with two glasses of iced tea. Sits beside her.

HARMONY
Anything?

RAVEN
(shaking her head)
The calls won't go through. My aunt in Savannah says Tasha's whole street is just... not there on the news. Just slabs. Where the houses were.

The phone buzzes in her hands. A text. She almost drops it.

SMS, from TASHA (228 area code): "ALIVE. me and the babies. water came to the 2nd floor. we was on the church roof on 34th st all day. a man in a boat took us to the high school. no power no water no nothing. tell grandma. love u Rae"

Raven reads it twice. Then she puts her face in her hands and sobs. Harmony holds her.

HARMONY
(rocking her)
They're alive. They're alive.

RAVEN
(into Harmony's shoulder)
A man in a boat. (beat) Somebody just came. In a boat.

They sit. Down the block, a car door closes. Raven lifts her head and wipes her face.

RAVEN
(looking at the empty driveway)
Where's Marc?

HARMONY
(beat)
His sister's birthday.

RAVEN
(gently)
It's ten-forty, Harmony.

Harmony looks down at her iced tea. Her hand drifts to her pocket. The folded letter, still there.

HARMONY
(quiet)
I know where he is.

37 EXT. WORLD'S FAIR MARINA - FLUSHING BAY - DOCK - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 11:18 PM

A long wooden dock lit by sodium lamps. Sailboats knock gently at their moorings. Across the bay, the runway lights of LaGuardia. A plane roars low overhead and the water shivers.

At the end of the dock: the Clarence, a weathered 1978 sailboat, with a string of white Christmas lights along the boom. Esther sits on the cabin roof in a sweatshirt and jeans, her knees pulled up, waiting.

Marc walks down the dock. He stops at the edge of the boat.

ESTHER
(quiet)
You're sober.

MARC
Two cups of my mother's tea. Nothing else. (beat) Permission to come aboard?

ESTHER
(beat)
Granted.

He climbs on and sits on the cabin roof beside her. Another plane. They wait for it to pass.

MARC
(after a long moment)
Esther. (beat) My mother is Natasha Donohue. Everybody knows that. (beat) My mother's father is Victor Donohue.

Esther doesn't move.

MARC
The Victor Donohue. The Foundation. The Donohue Medal. The children's hospitals. The building at Hopkins with his name on it, where I went to medical school and never once told anybody. (beat) That was him at the loading dock the morning Kingston died. He's the one who got the astronaut on the phone. (beat) The house on 49th Avenue isn't a graduation present from my parents. It's one of his. They're all his. (beat) And one day... a lot of it is supposed to be mine.

A long, long silence. The boat rocks.

ESTHER
(finally, very quietly)
Donohue. (beat) I thought it was a coincidence. The Chief's name. Everybody thinks it's a coincidence. It's a common enough name. (beat) That was the point, wasn't it.

MARC
That was the point.

ESTHER
(turning to look at him)
Who else knows?

MARC
My family. Graves. Gloria, probably. Big Ray. Amond. Arianna figured it out on her own. (beat) Not Harmony. Not Raven. (beat) And now you.

ESTHER
(beat)
Why me?

MARC
(looking at her)
Because you told me not to tell you drunk. (beat) Because you're the only person who ever asked me to make it a choice. (beat) And I choose you.

Esther looks at him for a very long time. Her hand goes to the chain at her neck. She holds the ring through her sweatshirt.

ESTHER
(barely audible)
Marc, I have to tell you something too. About Boston. About why I... (she stops)

He waits. She can't. Her eyes fill.

MARC
(gently)
Later can still be later. (beat) Somebody very smart told me that.

She laughs, a broken, wet laugh, and leans her forehead against his shoulder.

ESTHER
(into his shoulder)
Soon. I promise. Not tonight. (beat) Tonight I just want to have heard yours.

38 INT. THE CLARENCE - CABIN - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 29, 2005 - 11:47 PM

A tiny cabin: a V-berth, a two-burner galley, books stacked everywhere, a photo of five sisters taped above the sink. Esther's RAZR sits on the little table. It lights up. A 617 number. It buzzes.

Esther looks at it. Then, deliberately, she reaches over and holds down the power button until the screen goes black.

MARC
(watching her)
Who was that?

ESTHER
(beat)
Later. (beat) You said.

She turns to him. She takes his face in her hands and kisses him, slow and sure. When she pulls back, they're both breathing hard.

ESTHER
(whispering)
Stay.

MARC
(whispering)
You sure?

ESTHER
(smiling)
You just told me you're a billionaire's grandson on a boat that cost less than your couch. (beat) I'm very sure, Marc.

She reaches up and turns off the Christmas lights.

END OF ACT FIVE

TAG

39 INT. THE CLARENCE - CABIN - NIGHT
TUESDAY, AUGUST 30, 2005 - 4:50 AM

Before dawn. The galley lamp on low. Marc asleep in the V-berth, one arm hanging off the side. Esther, awake, sits at the little table in his Howard T-shirt, her powered-off phone in her hand.

She turns it on. "1 New Voicemail." She looks over at Marc sleeping. She puts the phone face down without listening.

Then she reaches behind her neck, unclasps the chain and, for the first time, takes off the ring. She sets it on the table beside the phone. Looks at the two of them, side by side.

She drops the ring into the galley drawer, beside a MiniDV tape, and closes it.

Then she crawls back into the V-berth and fits herself against Marc. He pulls her in without waking.

40 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - MORNING
TUESDAY, AUGUST 30, 2005 - 5:52 AM

Gray dawn. Amond asleep in the chair, his neck at a terrible angle. Robert's chair is empty: on it, a folded jacket and the list, now covered front and back in two sets of handwriting. At the bottom, in Robert's neat print: "200. Went to shower. Your turn. -R.B."

Curtis, extubated overnight, watches the muted TV. The chyron: "NEW ORLEANS: UP TO 80 PERCENT OF CITY UNDER WATER. 17TH STREET CANAL LEVEE BREACHED."

The bedside phone rings. Amond jolts awake and grabs it.

AMOND
(into the phone)
CCU, Dr. Baker. (beat, sitting up fast) Yes. Yes, he's right here. (to Curtis) It's Lionel.

He holds the phone to Curtis's ear. Curtis's eyes fill instantly.

CURTIS
(hoarse)
Lionel? (beat) Where's... (beat)
Put her on. Put her on.

A long pause. Then Curtis's whole face crumples.

CURTIS
(into the phone, crying)
Mama. (beat) You chopped through the roof? With Daddy's hatchet? (laughing, sobbing) On the I-10. A man in a boat. (beat) I'm okay, Mama. A baby doctor put a pump in me. (beat) He stayed up all night calling you.

Amond turns away to the window so nobody can see his face.

MARC (V.O.)
Everybody wants to be saved.

41 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - CORRIDOR - MORNING
TUESDAY, AUGUST 30, 2005 - 7:22 AM

Danielle on a gurney, rolling toward the OR doors. Kevin walks beside her, holding her hand. Lowery walks ahead, already in his cap. Marc and Harmony push the gurney.

KEVIN
(at the doors)
See you on the other side, Mrs. Hollis.

DANIELLE
(smiling, pre-op calm)
Not legally for two more days.

KEVIN
I don't care.

MARC (V.O.)
Nobody wants to be the one who needs it. But the people who survive the flood aren't the ones who never needed saving.

The doors swing shut behind her. Kevin stands in the hallway. Harmony stays with him. Marc looks down the corridor.

Esther comes off the elevator, hair still damp, in fresh scrubs. No chain at her collar today. She catches Marc's eye. A small, private smile. He smiles back.

MARC (V.O.)
They're the ones who climbed into the attic, found the hatchet and made a hole in the roof. (beat) And then they waved.

In Esther's hand, her RAZR buzzes. She glances down.

SMS, from 617-555-0144: "Landing JFK Thursday the 8th. 4:15pm. I'm coming to see you, Es. -C"

The smile freezes on her face. Down the hall, Marc doesn't see it. He's already turning toward the OR.

MARC (V.O.)
Somebody's always coming in a boat. (beat) You just have to let them see you.

Esther slips the phone into her pocket. Her hand goes to her collar, where the ring used to be. Nothing there.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 1x08

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Tuesday, August 23, 2005, 7:40 PM

"Dr. X is BACK. Confirmed sightings at the Board at 5:58 AM, in scrubs, holding a coffee one of his roommates was clearly holding for him. A certain Gary-born intern greeted him with a nickname we will not repeat, because it's catching on and we refuse to help. Welcome back, Dr. X. Eat lunch." Comments (88).

NATIONAL HURRICANE CENTER: Hurricane Katrina Advisory Number 26

Sunday, August 28, 2005, 10:00 AM CDT

"...KATRINA... A POTENTIALLY CATASTROPHIC CATEGORY FIVE HURRICANE... HEADED FOR THE NORTHERN GULF COAST... MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS ARE NEAR 175 MPH... COASTAL STORM SURGE FLOODING OF 18 TO 22 FEET ABOVE NORMAL TIDE LEVELS... LOCALLY AS HIGH AS 28 FEET..."

THE TIMES-PICAYUNE (nola.com breaking-news blog)

Monday, August 29, 2005, 9:03 AM CDT

"Floodwaters are rising rapidly in the Lower 9th Ward and St. Bernard Parish after a breach on the Industrial Canal, officials said. Residents trapped in attics are calling for help. Some have reported water up to the rooflines. The National Weather Service has issued a flash flood warning for the area..."

AP: "BUSH MARKS MCCAIN'S BIRTHDAY IN ARIZONA"

Monday, August 29, 2005

"PHOENIX (AP) -- President Bush, on a trip to promote the Medicare prescription drug benefit, celebrated Sen. John McCain's 69th birthday on an airport tarmac in Arizona today, as Hurricane Katrina battered the Gulf Coast..."

AIM: away message, DoubleOHarmony (Harmony Divine)

Monday, August 29, 2005, 12:10 PM

"Pound cake is DONE and it is PERFECT. Praying for New Orleans, Mississippi and everybody's family. Daddy: 9/6 10:30. I WILL be calling to remind you."

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Raven Ellison and Harmony Divine)

Monday, August 29, 2005, 1:58 PM

Raven: "graves said GOOD to me"

Harmony: "GOOD good or good like 'go away' good"

Raven: "GOOD good"

Harmony: "!!!!!!!"

Raven: "still nothing from tasha"

Harmony: "keep trying. im here"

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Monday, August 29, 2005, 11:58 PM

"Tonight in the chapel: a wedding. A REAL one. Well, a mostly real one (paperwork Thursday). The bride was in a wheelchair and a hospital gown with a tulle veil. Dr. Lowery, yes, THAT Dr. Lowery, walked her down the aisle and was seen, by multiple witnesses, crying. An intern sang Stevie Wonder and made the Rosary ladies weep. Monty from Monty's on Jackson catered with Martinelli's. Big Ray attended and pretended he was on duty. Whoever arranged this: we see you, Dr. X." Comments (143).

THE NEW YORK TIMES (front page)

Tuesday, August 30, 2005

"HURRICANE SLAMS INTO GULF COAST; DOZENS ARE DEAD"

"Hurricane Katrina pounded the Gulf Coast with devastating force at daybreak on Monday, sparing New Orleans the catastrophic direct hit that had been feared but inundating much of the city..."

CNN: on-screen chyron

Tuesday, August 30, 2005, 5:52 AM

"NEW ORLEANS: UP TO 80 PERCENT OF CITY UNDER WATER. 17TH STREET CANAL LEVEE BREACHED."

Red Cross Family Links Registry (entry)

Tuesday, August 30, 2005, 2:14 PM

"LEMIEUX, ODILE (69), Caffin Ave., New Orleans, LA 70117. Status: SAFE AND WELL. Location: evacuated by boat to I-10 overpass; transferred to Louis Armstrong International Airport. Message: 'Tell Curtis I saw the baby doctor's number on Lionel's phone 200 times. Tell him thank you.'"

Continuity Sheet: Episode 1x08

New Canon Established

- **Marc's EAP session** with Dr. Loretta Wise (Monday, August 22, 8:00 AM, Suite 410). She cleared him for duty starting Tuesday, August 23, capped him at 80 hours, banned extra shifts with Crump, and told him to come back on his own "when it happens again." Her grandmother ran the Williams Dreamland Theatre in Greenwood, Tulsa (burned in 1921, rebuilt). Marc on his crash-outs: "It's the quietest I ever get." Wise's MA-005 Season 5-6 recurring run is unchanged; these are early, single appearances.
- **Marc told Esther, sober,** at 11:18 PM on Monday, August 29, 2005, on the deck of the Clarence (World's Fair Marina): Victor Donohue is his grandfather, the house is Victor's, and "one day a lot of it is supposed to be mine." He did *not* tell her about the formal heir designation (the 2001 will and the sealed letter). Natasha gave her blessing on the Riverside Drive stoop. Victor, through Natasha: "He's the one I picked, Tasha. He'll do it right."
- **Marc and Esther slept together** on the Clarence (the first time since the night before July 1). Esther began to tell him about Boston and stopped. She took off the ring for the first time and put it in the galley drawer beside the MiniDV tape.
- **Clayton Hartwell thread:** his voicemail says he accepted Columbia's maternal-fetal medicine fellowship and that "we're still married." Esther saved it. His text: **landing at JFK Thursday, September 8, 2005, at 4:15 PM.** This sets up the season finale.
- **Natasha told Robert** who her father was on their second date (fall 1976, a Georgia Avenue diner, Howard homecoming). He said "Who?"
- **Robert's father Walter** died in 1999 of a heart attack in a D.C. Metrobus depot while Robert was operating in Queens. Robert and Amond split the 200 calls. Amond told Curtis about Stocker Street (1988: the back seat, eleven minutes).
- **Elxa turns 28;** she's 16 weeks pregnant and felt the baby move for the first time ("like popcorn"). Fetal heart rate is 152. She wears Grandma Joan's pearls, passed from Joan to Natasha to Elxa. Victor sent white Alaska peonies and sang on the phone at 6 AM. Grace (MS3, Harvard) started her surgery rotation at MGH today.
- **Arianna** cover story for Marc: "His grandfather drove a bus in D.C." That's true of Walter Bullock. She sent groceries to Gary instead of cash (Gloria's advice), and her mother said, "My Ari?"
- **Harmony** booked Howard's chest X-ray: Tuesday, September 6, 2005, 10:30 AM, QGH Pulmonary Clinic. Her parents are teasing her about "that boy." She knows where Marc spent the night.
- **Raven's cousin Tasha** and her two children survived in Gulfport, MS, on a church roof on 34th Street and were rescued by boat. Graves told Raven "Good." Graves: a grandmother in Beaufort, SC (a horseshoe over the door) and operations in a tent in Kosovo, both new canon.
- **Gloria** has an oldest son who "had a different emergency every Sunday" (new canon).

- **Amond's birthday** (February 10): "Nobody's ever sat with me on one." Robert: "Noted." Pay this off in 1x14 or 1x15.

Knowledge Tracker: Marc's True Identity (as of August 30, 2005)

Knows	Suspects / partial	Doesn't know
Family, Bernie, Graves, Gloria, Mrs. Truitt, Amond, Big Ray, Arianna, **Esther (told directly, 8/29; not the formal heir designation)**	Crump; Kendra and Deb (Town Car rumor, deflected by Arianna)	Raven, Harmony, Monty, Celia Montague, Dr. Wise (she knows he's the Chief's son), the press; Julian Whitmore (C-073)

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Danielle Pryor	2/17/1979 (26)	BRCA1 carrier; MRI-detected 9 mm invasive ductal carcinoma, grade 3, left breast (receptors pending)	Bilateral mastectomy, left sentinel node biopsy and tissue expanders on 8/30 (Lowery)	In surgery at end of episode
Ozella Rivers	1/30/1934 (71)	4.8 cm left frontal convexity meningioma; seizure	Craniotomy, Simpson grade I resection (Graves; Esther). Mojo kept in her sock	Extubated; anomia resolved
Curtis Lemieux	4/9/1961 (44)	Dilated cardiomyopathy, EF 12%, UNOS Status 1A; VT arrest 9:21 AM	Defibrillation (Amond); HeartMate XVE LVAD bridge to transplant (Robert; Amond)	Pump flow 5.1 L/min; extubated; mother found safe
Elxa Bullock	8/29/1977 (28)	Pregnancy, 16 weeks	Doppler check	Fetal heart rate 152, first movement felt

New Characters (to add to MA-005 and MA-006)

- **Danielle Pryor-Hollis** (b. February 17, 1979), a financial analyst and CFA candidate; **Kevin Hollis** (b. November 2, 1975), MTA Bridges and Tunnels (Brooklyn-Battery Tunnel); **Gladys Hollis** (b. 1948), Canarsie. Danielle's mother died at 38 (1991) and her sister Kia at 31 (2003).
- **Mother Ozella Rivers** (b. January 30, 1934), Gullah Geechee, born on St. Helena Island, SC, now living in South Jamaica, Queens; **Bernice Rivers-Lane** (b. June 6, 1957), a nursing-home aide; grandson Desmond (mentioned).
- **Curtis Lemieux** (b. April 9, 1961), a jazz trombonist from Caffin Avenue in the Lower Ninth Ward; **Odile Lemieux** (b. 1936), his mother; **Lionel Lemieux** (b. 1955), his brother.
- **Dr. Abraham Lowery** (b. January 9, 1947), breast and general surgeon, QGH, recurring. **Dr. Cynthia Braxton** (b. 1960), breast radiologist. **Rev. Wendell Amos** (b. 1944), QGH chaplain. **Nurse Pauline Greer** (b. 1965), OR circulator.

- **Ahmad Cummings** (b. September 9, 1984), heard on the phone. **Tasha** (Raven's cousin, Gulfport). **Dr. Clayton Hartwell** is heard for the first time (V.O. voicemail).

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- Hurricane Katrina: the first-ever mandatory evacuation of New Orleans was ordered on Sunday, August 28. Katrina made landfall near Buras, LA, at 6:10 AM CDT (7:10 AM EDT) on Monday, August 29, as a Category 3 with about 125 mph winds, and again near the Louisiana-Mississippi border at about 10 AM CDT. About 9,000-10,000 people sheltered in the Superdome, which lost part of its roof. The Industrial Canal floodwall breach flooded the Lower Ninth Ward that morning, trapping residents in attics (many used axes or hatchets to escape through roofs). The 17th Street Canal breach was widely reported on August 30, with about 80% of the city flooded. Gulfport and Biloxi were devastated by surge, and cell networks were overwhelmed, with text messages often getting through when calls did not. President Bush was in Arizona with Sen. McCain on August 29. Other news: Pat Robertson's Chávez remark (August 22) and Israel's Gaza withdrawal (completed August 22-23).
- Medicine: BRCA1 lifetime breast cancer risk is up to about 85%. Hartmann et al. (NEJM, 1999) and Rebbeck et al. (JCO, 2004) showed about a 90% risk reduction from bilateral prophylactic mastectomy. Screening breast MRI in high-risk young women was established practice by 2005, and BRCA1 tumors are typically triple-negative. Meningioma: Simpson grading. Milrinone for inotrope-dependent heart failure, UNOS Status 1A, and the HeartMate XVE LVAD as a bridge to transplant (FDA 1998) are period-accurate.
- New York: a marriage license has a 24-hour waiting period before the ceremony (DRL §13-b). The chapel ceremony is religious only, with the license on Thursday. Gullah terms *comeyah* and *binyah*, and mojo or root-doctor traditions of the Sea Islands, are authentic. World's Fair Marina sits on Flushing Bay beside LaGuardia. Terrace on the Park is a real Flushing Meadows venue.